



Great White's genes decoded

Scientists have decoded the great white shark's genes, revealing how they heal so rapidly and avoid cancer. <https://digit.in/mar19-06>



Test to measure pain

Researchers have developed a test that objectively measures pain biomarkers in blood. <https://digit.in/mar19-07>



PREDICTING YOUR HEALTH

With enough data on its hands, a patent application from Google hints at a future where your next major health problem can be predicted in advance.

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ack in May 2018, Owkin, a medical research machine learning startup, received \$5 million in

Series A follow-on funds from GV, Alphabet's venture investment arm. For the uninitiated, Alphabet is the parent company of Google that was created when the organisation went through a

massive restructuring back in 2015. Cut to 2019, in February, the US Patent and Trademark Office published a Google patent about a predictive EHR system. The patent was apparently filed back in 2017 and hasn't been granted yet.

EHR

Before we explain why this is important, it is essential to know what EHR is. Electronic health records, or EHRs, are an organised collection of patient data that can be shared across different

healthcare situations. In terms of the data stored, EHR may include a wide variety of markers like demographics, medical history, medication and allergies, immunization status, laboratory test results, radiology images, vital signs, personal statistics like age and weight, and billing information. Such a system allows doctors to access all of this information about a patient, new or old, as it is usually linked to identifiers such as social security numbers in the US. However, if technology based on the Google patent application came to be, their usefulness could go beyond that.

THE PATENT

The Google patent in question intends to use EHR in multiple ways by subjecting it to machine learning.